

INTERNSHIP REPORT

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Internship at CRY: A Journey Through Data, Policy, and Purpose

CRY also known as Child Rights and You stands as one of India's foremost non-governmental organizations dedicated to ensuring that every child enjoys the basic right to survival, education safety and development. Founded with the vision of creating a world in which every child is cherished, nurtured and allowed to flourish, CRY has worked tirelessly across the country to support communities, empower families and influence policy. As a research intern at CRY during the months of May and June I had the privilege of witnessing firsthand how data and analysis can drive meaningful change for children and women across India.

My first assignment involved an in-depth review of official notices issued by all states and union territories pertaining to four key committees entrusted with child protection education and health nutrition. I immersed myself in the guidelines for School Management Committees Village Child Protection Committees Ward Child Protection Committees and Village Health Sanitation and Nutrition Committees. Sifting through dozens of documents I highlighted the indicators that would serve as benchmarks for monitoring the effectiveness of each committee. This exercise not only deepened my understanding of India's federal structure but also underscored the complexity of ensuring uniform child welfare standards across diverse regions.

Building upon that foundation I turned my attention to the parliamentary record. I compiled data on questions raised in both the Lok Sabha and the Rajya Sabha regarding women and child welfare. Parsing through hours of transcripts I collated not only the questions themselves but also the official responses provided by concerned ministries. This task revealed the recurring themes of nutrition education and marginalization that permeate national discourse. Tracing these threads through multiple years of parliamentary sessions allowed me to identify shifts in policy focus and emerging areas of concern.

From Research to Reflection: Writing, Learning, and Growing

Once the data collection was complete I embarked on categorization. I designed a framework to classify each question and answer into five broad categories: rural issues caste dynamics gender concerns national policy and regional priorities. The process demanded careful consideration as many parliamentary interventions spanned multiple themes. Grouping them effectively required both analytical rigor and empathy with the lived realities behind each entry. It was in this phase that I truly appreciated how quantitative analysis must be grounded in the human stories it represents.

With categories defined I proceeded to a longitudinal analysis examining trends from 2019 through 2024 for both houses of Parliament. Employing statistical tools I charted the frequency of each theme year by year uncovering notable increases in questions related to nutrition in marginalized communities and highlights of gender equity measures. Presenting these findings in clear narrative form to my supervisors reinforced my ability to translate raw

data into actionable insights. It was immensely satisfying to see how my work could inform CRY's advocacy strategies and focus areas.

Beyond the parliamentary research I was invited to lend my voice to a blog post for the Centre for Child and Youth Justice at NALSAR University of Law. The piece titled *When the Internet Turns Unsafe for Children* explored the growing threats that online spaces pose to young users. Crafting this post allowed me to blend my analytical skills with creative writing offering readers not only a critique of existing policies but also recommendations for stronger safeguards. The positive feedback I received from faculty and fellow interns gave me a renewed sense of purpose and confidence in my writing abilities.

Throughout my internship the supportive environment at CRY nurtured my professional growth. My supervisors offered guidance and constructive feedback at every step encouraging me to refine my research methods and sharpen my writing style. Interacting with colleagues who shared a deep commitment to child rights inspired me to approach challenges with both intellectual curiosity and moral conviction. I found myself eager each morning to tackle the day's tasks knowing that my contributions no matter how small could ripple outward to benefit countless children.

Reflecting on my two-month journey I feel profound gratitude for the opportunity to contribute to CRY's mission. The work I carried out has reinforced my belief in the power of evidence-based advocacy and the importance of amplifying marginalized voices. As I look ahead to future endeavors I am confident that the skills I honed here—from policy analysis to narrative construction—will serve me well in any path I choose. More importantly I leave with the conviction that collective efforts guided by data empathy and determination can indeed transform the lives of India's most vulnerable children.